

Term	Course	Primary Dept	Primary Division	Enrolled: 123
Fall 2025	EP&E 4295 01/PLSC 2600 01 - Game Theory& Political Science	PLSC	Social Sciences	Responded: 95
Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#1 What knowledge, skills, and insights did you develop by taking this course?

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 62

Respondent	Answer
1877131	I learnt about game theory and how it related to political science.
1877152	I learned how to analyze political games in a quick and efficient manner.
1877156	I learned about game theory basics and its application to political science.
1878689	Through this course, I not only learned the fundamentals of game theory, but also learned how game theory is applied to political science. I learned to turn real-life situations into games and solve for the equilibrium of those games.
1880264	Fundamentals of game theory for non-sequential and sequential games
1882221	I learned the basics of game theory (pure & mixed strategy Nash Equilibria, extensive form games, Bayesian Nash Equilibria).
1882733	The course material was very interesting but complicated. Its not intuitive (especially as the course progresses) and it can be very hard to wrap your head around. Even still, I did feel like I gained a good framework of thinking.
1883443	This was my fourth semester of economics material at Yale and the first I truly enjoyed. I gained a comprehensive understanding of Game Theory, but beyond that I genuinely believe this course taught me a valuable new lens with which to view the world. I have a new angle and toolset for looking at decision-making (both my own and that of other actors). This class genuinely changed the way I think in a positive way which is what every course should aim to achieve.
1886554	Knowledge of game theory and games, how to strategize and figure out mind games.
1886842	I learned a lot about game theory as I had never taken the course before
1889700	Learned game theory and its applications to the political world exactly as advertised!
1891576	A very nice introduction to game theory for someone who was definitely worried about taking a QR credit it was nice to find one that combined with political science. It was also a good setting to look at political issues through a new lens.
1895182	I learned several basic game theory concepts and the theoretical frameworks they are founded on. I also learned how to use traditional notation and appropriately articulate my solutions.
1895677	Game theory was interesting, but also challenging.
1897745	Learned about game theory concepts and problems and how to approach them.
1898429	You learn about how to analyze games and how it relates to some political science topics.
1904393	Really good intro survey to game theory. Basic game theory methods and practice with algebra and systems of equations.
1906442	Turns out I can do math
1911279	very basic game theory with some moderate applications to political science
1912231	Intro to game theory problems
1914374	I learned the basics of game theory really well.
1914845	I learned some of the fundamentals of game theory and some interesting applications to political science.
1914889	We learnt the very basics of Game Theory but since this is a Political Science class we only covered examples that were relatively easy and not too computational which was great! We started off with basic Game solving with regular matrices, the Prisoners Dilemma etc. We examined Best Response in Pure strategy and then added light probability to advance into Mixed Strategy. We then added Game Trees and sequential game after which we advanced into probably the hardest (but not equally weighted) part of the course, Bayesian games with probability. Overall, the exercises that we solved werent too hard or too complicated which was great! Even though it was a political science class, the focus wasnt so much on political science applications, but rather on actually learning the basics of Game Theory.
1915978	Why gas stations must be placed close to each other even at the expense of profit. All that is to say, not much.
1916850	A good sense of game theory and its relations to government

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#1 What knowledge, skills, and insights did you develop by taking this course?

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 62

Respondent	Answer
1916851	I learned about Nash equilibrium, subgames, mixed Nash equilibrium, Bayesian Nash equilibrium and perfect Bayesian Nash equilibrium. How to read and create game trees, variations of games, etc.
1916857	I learned Bayes theorems and nash equilibrium, which helps me contextualize a lot of decisions made in our political climate.
1916912	I learned game theory of political science.
1916916	I was able to learn about the logic of decision making and what strategies are necessary to make the best decision.
1917004	I learned more about how game theory is involved in our lives. It also let me think in a more rational and comprehensive way that shows me how probability and logic can lead to solutions.
1917159	Intro level game theory strategies.
1917347	Learned about pure strategy and mixed strategy Nash equilibria, modeling electoral competition, subgame perfect Nash equilibria in sequential games, modeling policy and agenda setting, the grim trigger strategy in repeated games, and Bayesian Nash equilibria and perfect Bayesian equilibria in Bayesian and signaling games.
1917831	I learned a great deal about theoretical game theory.

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#2 Your level of engagement with the course was:
Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 20

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
3.7 ±1.0	3.8 ±1.0	3.9 ±1.0	3.9 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
very low	2
low	7
medium	16
high	33
very high	17

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Instructors Turner, Ian (P)				

#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 58

Respondent	Answer
1877131	Strengths: Lecture was recorded so we could slow down the material that was being taught. Weakness: Professor Turner teaches material though having a presentation. In a class where there is math, its hard to follow along when the math is typed out. We cant see what is going on in real time as everything is typed. Coupled with the amount of material we are being taught, its incredibly difficult to follow along during lecture. Furthermore, the pointer never works, making it even harder to see where in the lecture Professor Turner is pointing to. I believe having a lecture format where Professor Turner can write things out in real time, especially when were moving from matrix to matrix, can help facilitate learning much more.
1877152	I would make attendance mandatory.
1877156	This course was a lot harder and challenging than I expected. I think this is partially due to the fact that the professor would not explain things properly during lecture. He would not even use his pointer to show for example how the spatial models work and cared more about slide aesthetics than actually making sure we understood. I think the lectures need to be more interactive in at least using the pointer to show how each concept can be solved.
1878689	Professor Turner does not assume any prior knowledge, and only high school algebra is required for this course. Professor Turner is very patient and explains every detail. Overall, this is a great class for learning game theory. While the connection to political science is there, I would say the course is still 80% game theory, and that could be a strength or weakness depending on the student.
1880264	Genuinely very strong all around! I thought the entire course was very well-organized and clear, and I feel that I came away with a thorough understanding of the material.
1882221	Strengths: I learned a lot from this course, and I found that the exams were very fair and straightforward, rewarding students who were understanding the p-sets. I went to all lectures (except for one, due to extenuating circumstances) and sections (both lectures and sections are optional; lectures are recorded), and I did the p-sets, going to office hours for help as needed, and outside of that, my studying for exams was minimal, and I found this class to be easy. There was a direct correlation with the work that I put into this course and my performance. The workload was very reasonable, in my opinion, and I did very well in this course. Also, Prof. Turner is funny and made lectures enjoyable. And the TFs are great! Super helpful office hours! Weaknesses: None come to mind -- I think this course is exactly how it should be for an intro game theory course!
1882733	Strengths: the TFs, course material (was interesting), and Professor Turner is a conversational lecturer Weaknesses: content was unnecessarily convoluted at times, the Psets often had errors, and the exams could be equally complicated for no reason
1883443	Strengths: Professor Turner is magnetic and truly brings life to the content I can think of no weaknesses
1884485	Strength: very well-organized course material, easy to get help
1886554	Great course! Attendance is optional since the lectures are recorded, which is nice if you're sick, but you definitely get more out of the course by going. Prof. Turner was amazing, very approachable and funny, and as someone who had never heard of game theory before taking the class, I got a ton out of it and found it super interesting.
1886842	Strengths: i thought it was great and as someone who is not great at math it was manageable and a great class
1888074	Excellent professor
1889700	Strengths: Prof. Turner, office hours, problem sets that directly relate to lecture material (I always felt prepared), on that note, exams that very closely resembled problem sets no curve balls Weaknesses: Section often confused me, I understood the concepts better without going to section.

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#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 58

Respondent	Answer
1891576	I liked the content a lot, and I thought the pacing was good, but I feel like I had to rely on the TAs/TFs and my own research too much I often left the lecture a little bit too confused. I also didn't love the readings/handouts because there was no incentive to really use them beyond occasional practice problems when preparing for the exams.
1895182	The lecture schedule was very efficient and managed to thoroughly cover each topic and fit a review session in before the exams. The problem sets directly related to what we were covering in class and being tested on. I felt section was particularly helpful with the smaller details of notations and problem solving.
1895677	I wish the teaching support was better.
1897745	Strengths -- not a hard course if you do the readings, go to office hours, and pay attention in lecture. exams are fair. Prof turner is great, and always willing to meet with students. Weaknesses -- none.
1898429	This course was incredibly interesting in terms of content. The PSETS and exams were very fair, and the lectures were interesting. There was a lot of support in terms of material, with sections, the textbook, recordings, and TA notes. The only thing to be improved was more of a set schedule with PSETS.
1899642	Strengths: The course is extremely well organized. All the PSETs are quite doable, and exams are very similar to the level of the PSETs. Expectations are clearly communicated. Weaknesses: I found the lectures extremely unhelpful (to be fair, though, Prof. Turner is a great lecturer, I just found the material itself not the most relevant). They introduce insanely complicated math that isn't really that relevant to the processes the PSETs and exams expect of you. I also hate classes with no participation grade, which this class has none of. It makes it so you don't really develop a relationship with the instructor. I also think the "Political Science" part of it felt like an add-on rather than the focus of the course itself. I don't think my political science was enhanced much by this class, except for being able to follow arbitrary steps for the specific problems the class explores.
1904393	Hes taught it so much that its formulaic at this point, which makes it good because its very clear what you are supposed to learn but can feel a tad redundant/not engaging. I know improve engagement is a really unhelpful suggestion but thats what Id recommend; was kind of a bummer to see attendance fall so much over the semester. Also make discussion section mandatory. I never went. Also they shouldnt have double jeopardy on the test questions. I got part a of question 1 on my midterm wrong, proceeded to use precisely the exact correct method for the rest of the problem, and got the entire thing wrong got a 60% on the test because of that 1 question. Frustrating because in most classes they would perceive that youve learned it correctly just slightly misapplying it.
1906442	I found that the lectures werent very helpful but section and office hours were vital, which felt kind of odd.
1907739	The course is very well structured. It is very clear what is expected of you.
1911279	strengths - straight forward exams, sections are helpful weaknesses - lectures were convoluted, no office hours during non-class times which made it impossible to go, not enough practice problems, PARTIAL CREDIT NOT EXISTING ON SOME EXAMS!!! I am so incredibly angry I missed ONE letter in part A and because it was left out in the rest of the problem even though I showed my work and had quite literally every other part of the strategy correct through the rest of the parts, I nearly failed the test (despite getting full points on the remainder of the problems) This is a terrible way of assessing one's understanding and extremely unfair and detrimental
1914374	I think this course is run really well with the TA system and the lectures. The homework is clear and doable.
1914845	Strengths are that the course is interesting, and the discussion sections are helpful.

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Instructors Turner, Ian (P)				

#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 58

Respondent	Answer
1914889	STRENGTHS: GREAT class overall, really interesting content and I felt that I learnt the basics of Game Theory including Pure strategy basic games, Mixed Strategy, games with probability and beliefs, decision trees, signalling games etc. The class was wonderfully taught by Professor Turner who is phenomenal. He is so considerate and funny! The lecture slides were the perfect resource for studying and the exams were somewhat similar to what we had solved in lectures and problem sets. Sections were also helpful. Grading was generous at the end and the workload wasn't crazy. Although not a poli sci gut, it is easy to get a good grade and it's actually an interesting class, you should take it!! WEAKNESSES: exams were not super hard, but some were VERY long! Some problem sets were also very long and took such a long time. I also found unnecessary the inclusion of those niche political science application lecture like the lemons market, political bargaining etc. They took up precious lecture time; they were super hard and didn't show up on exams anyway. I'd rather we did not do them, and we did some extra exercises and basic practice instead. Also, the Joel Watson textbook was really bad and useless. It was highly unnecessary; it was just a distraction. The lecture slides were great though and he had that to study! Moreover, even though I loved the content of the class, I didn't really like the Bayesian Games at the end. We didn't have much time to digest it, people who didn't know probability had trouble and it felt quite random how we just threw that topic at the very end..
1915978	Strength: My TF, Zoey--GOAT GOAT GOAT Weaknesses: Too many--where do I begin? This class was poorly taught in a way that did not successfully facilitate students' learning. Don't get me wrong, I bet Prof. Turner is a great guy, but I could not understand his teaching methods. 9/10 lectures, I would have to go to the library to relearn the material because I could not understand his teaching style. Don't even get me started on the exams--if you don't understand a certain nuance in the material, you WILL not do well. I repeat, YOU WILL NOT DO WELL IN THIS COURSE. You have been warned.
1916850	Very well organized course! Easy to follow along
1916851	No weaknesses - taught very well, professor Turner is the GOAT, the class is fun, TAs care about their students.
1916857	The lecturer is great. I thought the class was very straightforward.
1916912	In my opinion, the exams were not easy. However, they were not unreasonable, although the first midterm was definitely a time crunch. Just study the pssets and most importantly, the class slides closely.
1916916	The strengths are the recorded lectures and very open office hours to help further understanding of the concept. The weakness is the speed of lectures and the quantity of the content.
1917004	The strengths are the TFs and the resources provided. I would say that this course could be improved by having a better grading scale.
1917347	This course is a great introduction to game theory and using the frameworks from game theory to model real-world political science scenarios. The pssets provide great preparation for the exams, and the exams are fair and designed for you to be able to get 100% or close even within the shorter time frame of 50 minutes.
1917363	Overall, well-organized and great course! As far as feedback goes: 1) the final unit felt a bit rushed in comparison to the others, 2) some of the "political science" - examples of game theory that we went through in class / spent certain lectures on (for instance: president v senate) felt a bit out of place. For these political science applications to work, they could have been made a bit more complex: right now they often felt like very convoluted ways of explaining very simple dynamics that didn't relate directly to the other problem-solving methods we were learning.
1917636	Strengths: Professor Turner puts in a lot of effort and thought into the design of the course. He is a great lecturer; the TF's also design a section that helps conceptualize the material. All three of the exams were fair, although the last exam did have a lot of questions for the given amount of time, but allegedly there was a slight curve. The content on the problem sets matched what was assigned, which made them great study resources. Weakness: The only weakness is that I wish there were peer tutors. In many of the econ and intro bio/chem courses, peer tutors are a great tool to help students get comfortable with the material, and they often offer hours later in the day, which works for more people's schedules. In the future, if possible, it would be great to see the course have peer tutors. The problem sets were very important for your grade, but the office hours of the TFs were limited, which made it difficult for me to get help when needed. Also, PSETs make up a huge chunk of your grade, are harshly graded, and office hours are hard to make at times, making it difficult to get help when needed. My work schedule often overlapped with office hours.

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#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

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Respondent	Answer
1917831	The lectures were well taught and engaging, and the workload was quite manageable. I wish there were more resources around studying for final exams. In addition, the Teaching Fellows varied significantly in quality.

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#4 What is your overall assessment of this course?
Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 21

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
3.8 ±1.1	3.9 ±1.2	3.9 ±1.1	3.9 ±1.1

Choice Label	Counts
poor	2
fair	9
good	18
very good	20
excellent	25

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#5 The course was well organized to facilitate student learning.
Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 22

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.1 ±1.0	4.0 ±1.1	4.1 ±1.0	4.0 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
strongly disagree	2
disagree	3
neutral	15
agree	21
strongly agree	32

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#6 I received clear feedback that improved my learning.

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 21

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
3.8 ±1.0	3.8 ±1.1	3.8 ±1.1	3.9 ±1.1

Choice Label	Counts
strongly disagree	2
disagree	4
neutral	24
agree	24
strongly agree	20

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#7 Relative to other courses you have taken at Yale, the level of intellectual challenge of this course was:

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 20

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
3.3 ±0.9	3.1 ±0.9	3.3 ±0.9	3.3 ±0.9

Choice Label	Counts
much less	2
less	12
same	27
greater	28
much greater	6

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Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#8 Relative to other courses you have taken at Yale, the workload of this course was:
Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 21

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
2.9 ±0.8	2.9 ±0.9	2.9 ±0.9	3.1 ±0.9

Choice Label	Counts
much less	4
less	15
same	42
greater	11
much greater	2

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Instructors Turner, Ian (P)				

#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 52

Respondent	Answer
1877131	I would not recommend this class to another student. I feel that the teaching format of the class made it hard for me to actually engage with the material. Because exams are such a large part of the grade, students tend to resort to cramming everything in. While I understand that exams are crucial in classes like this to test proficiency, I also feel like for a Political Science class, I didnt see much of the political science aspect.
1877152	Yes, it was fun
1877156	No, I would not recommend this class unless you need it for your methodology. I had to learn everything on my own even though I went to every lecture.
1878689	Yes! I would recommend this class to anyone who might be interested in Game Theory. It is a truly fascinating topic, and this course makes sure students with different backgrounds can all follow along. The exams are very similar to the homework, so there isn't anything unexpected that would throw students off.
1879357	I would not recommend this course to fellow Humanities students looking for a quick QR; I would not recommend this course to anyone with 4 others classes; I would not recommend this course to anyone who might find themself not attending lecture consistently. But for everyone else, anyone else, anyone who would commit themself wholly to the course, it could not be better.
1880102	a gut
1880174	Yes! I thought the material was very interesting without being too difficult to understand. Good QR for more humanities-based people.
1880264	Yes! I really enjoyed this course, and I think it's super applicable to political science in general. Also a solid way to get the formal theory requirement for the major.
1882221	Yes! This is a great way to get a QR credit! It was fun and enjoyable. I learned and put in an appropriate amount of work and felt that the grading was very fair. Grades definitely correlate with effort! If you intend to not go to lecture and section and not really do the p-sets, then maybe you shouldn't take this course because there's nothing to hold you accountable, and you probably will not do well. However, if you are responsible, I would definitely take the course!
1882733	I would, but CR/D/Fail it. There is NO curve and yes, its about 6 Psets and 3 exams, but theyre HARD content-wise. Take the econ version for the curve or take this with the understanding that it is not a QR gut or easy methodology course for Poli Sci majors. It was genuinely difficult.
1883443	Absolutely! This course is fascinating & will teach you a different way to look at decisions
1884485	Yes - it's easy to see lots of applications and areas of interest related to the material
1886554	Yes! If you need a game theory class, take it with Turner! I would have taken this class even if I didn't need it for my major for sure
1886842	Yes!
1889700	I would! The course is set up in a way that makes it very easy to succeed problem sets are easy to do well on if you go to office hours, and midterms are fine and not graded harshly if youve taken the time to study and go to lecture. Content-wise, this course was so interesting, and I loved how I felt like I was solving little puzzles every day. Professor Turner is fantastic, couldnt recommend this course enough.
1891576	Yes, I think it was a solid class that I would definitely recommend for, say, other political science students and other students in the social sciences.
1893573	If you want a pretty interesting QR!
1895182	Yes! The class is fun and interesting and Professor Turner is a great lecturer!

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#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 52

Respondent	Answer
1895677	Required for major.
1897002	yes, amazing prof and TA Zoey and prof very much sets up class so you can succeed if you try
1897745	Yes -- great QR gut.
1898429	I would definitely recommend. The content is incredibly interesting and the professor is very engaging. He is very fair and cares about student learning. It offers a new perspective on decisions and games.
1899642	Its an easy QR for sure. Prof. Turner is a very skilled lecturer. I think if you really work on understanding concepts, this could be useful information to know. Otherwise its easy to just memorize steps, get through PSETs and exams, and call it a day. I'm not sure if it feels like the most intellectually rewarding class
1904393	Yes if you need it for a major, otherwise I might just take it with Polak. Smaller seminar style is good if thats for you, but Ive heard there was more engagement in his version lol.
1906442	YES TAKE IT! Especially if you need a QR credit! Seems kind of hard but then you always wind up knowing the material and doing well on the exams!
1907739	Yes! Unless you are interested in a more economic & financial side of things.
1911279	no, too risky with no partial credit on exams. I had to credit D despite doing extremely well in the rest of the class. Also the lectures are bad and don't prepare you. My learning was done outside of the classroom or there would be a lecture literally the class before the exam that would be helpful but it was too late
1912231	Yes. It is a great introduction even if you have no experience, lectures are very clear, TAs are helpful during office hours, tests are very fair and based on material covered in class as well as in the review session, no surprises there. For some reason the final grade is taking a very long time to come in but otherwise grading has been fast and fair.
1914374	Yes, I would because I think the professor teaches very clearly and it's very easy to learn complex topics.
1914845	Yes, I'd recommend to anyone interested in political science or game theory looking for an easier class.
1914852	probably!
1914889	Yes, this was a great class, please take it! It was easy overall and very interesting; it really felt like a basic introduction to Game Theory. We covered the basics like Pure Strategy, matrices, simple games, the prisoners dilemma, Best Response analysis and then moved on to more advanced topics like probability games, decision trees, Game Trees, Mixed strategy and Bayesian Games. Overall, it kind of felt like a gut, but it wasn't ridiculously easy, it was just doable to get an A. It was essentially an intro to Game Theory; we didn't really do much Political Science. HOWEVER, since it was a Political Science class, it was an easier introduction to Game Theory, and we didn't cover examples or topics that were harder or more mathematical. Professor Turner is also a great professor, so funny and considerate. The grading is generous, and the exams are super long but not very hard. YES, please take this class, even with no prior exposure to any Game Theory or anything relevant, even though having taken Micro was an important boost for me! Take it to fulfil the formal theory & methodology requirement or the Core lecture requirement for the Politics MAJOR OR the Game Theory requirement for EP&E, it is definitely the most straightforward, easiest, most interesting and best choice for both! I just warn this is a quantitative class, so if that's not your thing at all, that might be harder. Moreover, the problem sets do take a lot of time. Nonetheless, it is rewarding and it is a GREAT class to take!
1915978	NO. Let me repeat my previous statement of the weaknesses in this class: Too many--where do I begin? This class was poorly taught in a way that did not successfully facilitate students' learning. Don't get me wrong, I bet Prof. Turner is a great guy, but I could not understand his teaching methods. 9/10 lectures, I would have to go to the library to relearn the material because I could not understand his teaching style. Don't even get me started on the exams--if you don't understand a certain nuance in the material, you WILL not do well. I repeat, YOU WILL NOT DO WELL IN THIS COURSE. You have been warned.
1916841	Yes, especially if they are an EPE major looking to fulfill the game theory requirement. It covers the topics quickly compared to the other game theory class, but I personally preferred unit exams as opposed to the standard Econ one midterm and one cumulative final

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#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Turner, Ian (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 52

Respondent	Answer
1916850	Yes! A great overview of game theory that is not too hard
1916851	Yesssss I love this class it was so fun, pests were long but once you got the hang of it they were fun to go through.
1916857	Yes, I would recommend it to anyone interested in game theory, but probably not if they werent interested in math.
1916912	I would, its interesting and you get a good overview of the concepts. The professor himself is very nice and funny, and quite liked by all. He is also very approachable.
1916916	Yes because it is an interesting concept to learn and understand the logic behind the decision making.
1917004	I would recommend this course to another student because it does a great job introducing game theory and the professor is very kind.
1917347	Yes, this is a great class that covers the fundamental ideas in game theory that all majors should take!
1917636	I went into this course wanting to get it over with for the QR requirement, but this is one of my favorite courses I have taken at Yale. If you are interested in comparative government, game theory will come up in nearly every reading, lecture, etc. The political science version of the course is beautifully tailored to benefit you and apply to your major, so don't pass up the opportunity to take it. If you do take it, engage with the material! Go to section! DO NOT fall behind. If you don't understand something, go to office hours before it haunts you a week later. I am not saying this course is a gut for a QR course, but it also isn't impossible to tackle even if you aren't STEM inclined. If you are a political science major, and you take this class, put in work and effort to understand and apply the concepts. If you do, I would bet my bottom dollar you will love this course and take the knowledge and skills you learn from it outside of the course.
1917831	Yes, I would recommend this to any student interested in an introductory game theory class.

Term Fall 2025	Course EP&E 4295 01/PLSC 2600 01 - Game Theory& Political Science	Primary Dept PLSC	Primary Division Social Sciences	Enrolled: 123 Responded: 95
Instructors Turner, Ian (P)				

#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Pavlik, Melissa

Responses for Instructor: 7
Declined to Answer Question: 18

Respondent	Answer
1883443	Mel is amazing! So patient and caring. She genuinely cares about the complete understanding of every student in the room, and has a gift for breaking down complicated ideas into palatable pieces.
1898429	She was an incredible TA. She was great at clearly explaining content and making sure students understood the material. She offered a lot of material to learn from and her own notes. She was very engaging and cared about the students she was helping. She was a wonderful person as well!!
1911279	Very friendly and willing to help Notes could be more clear (would benefit from slides)
1914889	Mel was such a phenomenal T.F. and a great person! She was so efficient in teaching and above all cared for her students! She answered all our questions and was always there for us which students massively appreciate. She felt us and was ready to meet with us if we didnt get something or reply to our e-mails immediately. It was also very moving to see her be happy with our progress, she really made my experience in that class! Thank you, Mel, so happy to have had you as my TF and I wish you all the very best!
1916841	Amazing TF! I never missed a section because I knew Mel would make sure that I understood the content of that week before I left. Im very grateful for her support and encouragement
1916848	Mel was a phenomenal TF who was very helpful in helping students digest the course curriculum. She fostered my intellectual development through challenging me with advanced problems like the Coconut problem. I appreciate her teaching a lot!
1917004	She did a great job in taking the time to explain topics to us. She was very patient and knowledgable and very open to helping us in any way possible.

Term	Course	Primary Dept	Primary Division	Enrolled: 123
Fall 2025	EP&E 4295 01/PLSC 2600 01 - Game Theory& Political Science	PLSC	Social Sciences	Responded: 95
Instructors				
Turner, Ian (P)				

#11 What is your overall assessment of the Teaching Fellow?

Instructor(s): Pavlik, Melissa

Responses for Instructor: 17
Declined to Answer Question: 8

	Average and Standard Deviation		
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.2 ±1.0	4.1 ±1.1	4.3 ±1.0	4.3 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
poor	0
fair	2
good	1
very good	5
excellent	9

